UNIVERSITY OF
VISION
STRATEGY
OPPORTUNITY
WESTMINSTER

# How to connect to the University VPN?

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# 1. What is a VPN

A VPN - Virtual Private Network - connects remote computers (or networks) outside of a corporate network, such as the University network, so the remote computers appear to be inside the corporate network. This means the remote machines can use assets normally blocked from outside access by a firewall.

The University has a VPN called Palo Alto GlobalProtect, which allows home users to access facilities such as license servers which are inside the University network and protected from outside visibility by the firewall. You must be included on a list of VPN users to use the VPN. Open a ServiceDesk call if you need access and do not yet have it. Most CSE staff and some students (on particular modules) will already have VPN access.

From May 2024, all users will need to use the VPN to access internal services from outside the University network. All CSE staff and students will be added to the VPN permitted-user list.

Whilst connected to the VPN, all of your web traffic will go through the University network. You will have some restrictions applied by the University firewall as if you were using a machine inside the University network. So even using (for example) YouTube on your computer will have the videos streamed through the University. While YouTube is not blocked by the firewall, some software distribution sites (such as Kali's repository) and some less reputable websites may be. Disconnecting from the VPN will remove that block.

# 2. How to Install the University VPN

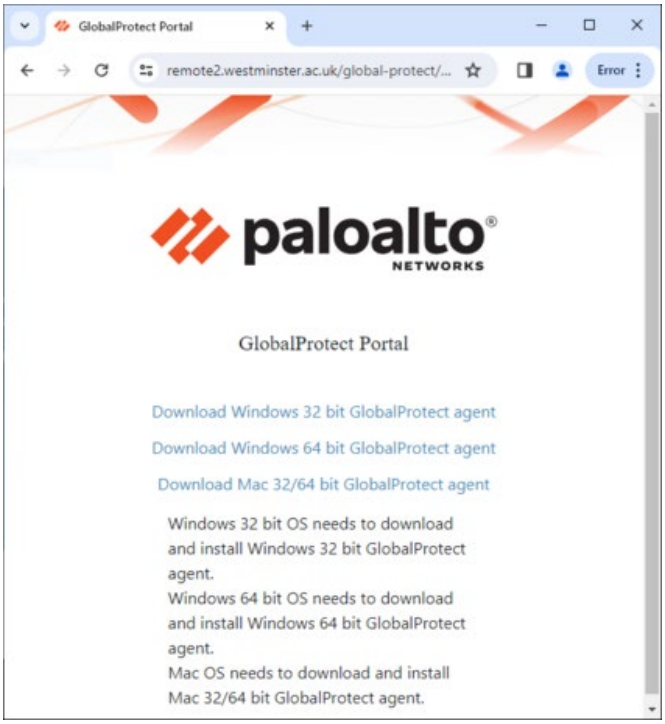
## 2.1. Video Demo

Demo of installing, configuring and connecting to the VPN:

- Windows: https://youtu.be/7xfgDJT8kZ4
- Mac: https://youtu.be/ql_ZHZodTVM

## 2.2. Installing the University VPN – Desktop/Laptop

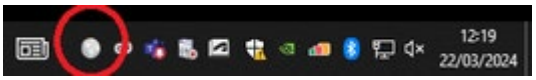
For a desktop or laptop, download the installer from remote2.westminster.ac.uk
Log in to this site with your normal username; select 32 or 64-bit Windows or 32/64-bit Mac to match your machine. Most Windows and all recent Mac installations will be 64-bit; if you do not know which Windows you have, right-click Computer or This PC in Windows Explorer and select Properties. Click on the example image on the right to enlarge.




## 2.2.1. Installing on a Windows machine

Run the downloaded file (e.g. GlobalProtect64.msi) by double-clicking it or opening it from the browser downloads menu, accept all the defaults and click [ Next > ] on each screen.

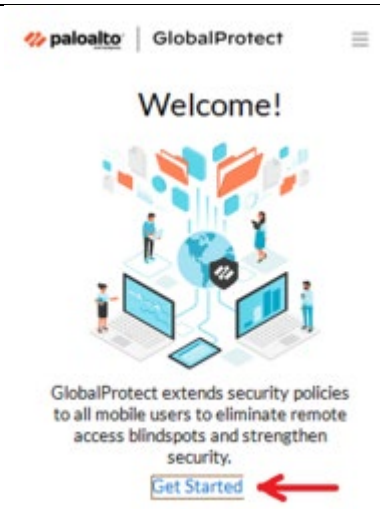
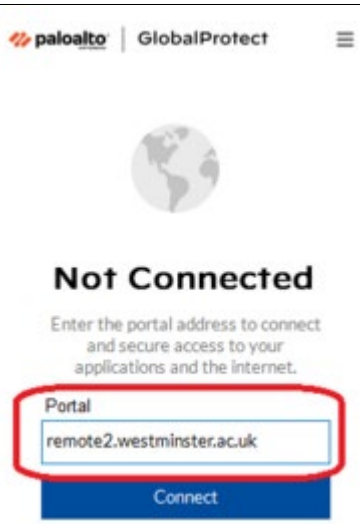
Once installed, a grey globe icon appears in the tooltray, near the time & date.




## 2.2.2. Connecting on a Windows machine

The first time you connect, you must add the server address.

Click the grey globe icon, and you get a popup; click "Get Started" at the bottom. Enter the portal address, **remote2.westminster.ac.uk** and click Connect.

| | |
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|  |  |
| VPN "Get Started" | VPN adding the portal address |

The VPN will then ask you to log in and use the Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), using your username@westminster.ac.uk and a code sent via your phone. University laptops may not ask for your username & password since you already authenticated with these to log in to the machine, and so may go directly to the Text/Call dialogue.

While connecting, the globe icon will show a moving black & white pattern, then turn blue/green when connected. You will get the option to "Stay signed in"; selecting [Yes] here may reduce the number of codes you have to type in if you have to disconnect and reconnect later.

After connecting once, GlobalProtect will remember the server setting, so you connect just by clicking the globe icon in the tooltray and doing the authentication.

## 2.2.3. Installing on a Mac machine

If you have the Unversity-installed Mac operating system, you should have a program called Apps@Westminster. You can install Global Protect VPN Client from this. Run Apps@Westminster (from LaunchPad), scroll down to the Global Protect app, click [Install] and follow the instructions.

Alternatively, you can download GlobalProtect.pkg from remote2.westminster.ac.uk and then install it (double-click the file or open it with the installer from the download).

Once installed, the VPN shows as a globe on the right of the (top-of-the-screen) menu bar, as shown in the screenshots in the Using section below. It will then show the login dialog.

## 2.3. Installing the University VPN – Mobile Devices

Tablets and phones can install **GlobalProtect** from their app store:

- search globalprotect vpn in the Apple App Store or Google Play Store
- Install the GlobalProtect app
- Set the server to remote2.westminster.ac.uk
- Set the user to your username@westminster.ac.uk (e.g. *w7654321@westminster.ac.uk*)
- Enter your password and the code (from a message on your phone) from the two-factor authentication.
- To disconnect, switch to the GlobalProtect app and Tap to **Disconnect**

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| Logo on the Apple Store | Logo on Google Play |

You can upload your video on OneDrive (or any other platform, including YouTube) and share the link in Appendix I of your report. Please be sure the video is easily accessible through the link included in your submission. The video must be accessible until the end of the summer (when you receive your definitive and approved grades).

# 3. USING THE VPN

Once installed,

1. open GlobalProtect; on Windows, select it from the [Start] menu, on Mac, pull it down from the globe icon on the right of the menu at the top of the screen.
2. wait a few seconds for the network analysis.
3. set the Portal to remote2.westminster.ac.uk
4. Log in by entering your University ID & password and clicking [Connect].
5. After a short connection procedure, it should then show Status: Connected.
6. You should now be able to access the University network's license servers and internal websites.

There will be some restrictions on accessing outside Internet sites, as your connection will now be going through the University firewall. Disconnect from the VPN if you need to access a blocked site.
The Windows and Mac dialogs look similar as of the 2020 release. The Mac dialog is accessed via a globe icon, top right on the menu bar; the Windows dialog is in the tooltray, usually bottom right, and you may need to click the up-arrow on the toolbar to find the globe icon.

Important: Disconnect when not needed
When you are not using a University network license or an internal website, disconnect. This will remove the University firewall restrictions from your Internet connection and free up VPN bandwidth for others.

# 4. Web Support

- Westminster VPN download site
- Vendors' Documentation